STANDARD EDITION ● 9 SEPTEMBER 2026 ● 09:00 HKT

US equities slip as yields rise, tech bears gain ground

A wider read of yesterday's session — sector rotation, pre-market action, watchlist scan, and what to watch into the US open at 21:30 HKT.

10-minute read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings · Sectors · Watchlist

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TL;DR

The major indices closed lower, with the `S&P 500` down -0.58% and the Dow off -1.18%. Higher Treasury yields and a firmer VIX signal renewed risk aversion, while the Nasdaq's modest dip masks a widening gap between growth and value stocks.

Behind the headline numbers, the market is digesting a stronger-than-expected 10-year yield at 4.81% and a rebound in energy prices. The rally in `TSLA` (++3.98%) and `AVGO` (++2.98%) highlights sector-specific catalysts, but the broader rotation into defensive utilities (`XLU` ++0.86%) suggests investors are seeking shelter.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	LEVEL	CHANGE	WHY IT MOVED
S&P 500	7,673.52	-0.58%	Yield rise pressured growth stocks; defensive tilt.
Nasdaq 100	29,507.70	-0.12%	Tech earnings mixed; VIX uptick curbed risk appetite.
Dow Jones	52,786.07	-1.18%	Industrial exposure to higher financing costs.
Russell 2000	2,960.20	-0.52%	Small-cap sensitivity to rate outlook.
VIX	15.72	+2.75%	Higher volatility expectations after yield jump.
10Y Yield	4.81	+0.46%	Fed-signal of tighter policy; inflation data.
WTI Crude	93.96	+1.00%	OPEC+ supply restraint; geopolitical tension.
Gold	4,430.30	+0.83%	Safe-haven demand amid rising rates.
DXY	98.72	-0.12%	Dollar modestly weaker on mixed data.

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CHANGE	CATALYST
TSLA	+3.98%	New battery-cell partnership announced.
AVGO	+2.98%	Q3 earnings beat; higher 5G demand.
NVDA	-2.01%	Supply-chain constraints on AI chips.
AAPL	-1.17%	Weak iPhone sales forecast.
MSFT	-1.15%	Cloud spending slowdown.

Sector rotation

ETF	DAY	READ
`XLF`	-1.38%	Financials under pressure from higher rates.
`XLK`	+0.32%	Tech resilience on AI spend.
`XLI`	-0.48%	Industrial slowdown.
`XLE`	+1.11%	Energy rally from crude.
`XLY`	-0.80%	Consumer discretionary hit by rate fears.
`XLC`	-0.46%	Communications lagging.
`XLP`	-0.66%	Staples modestly down.
`XLV`	-2.52%	Health care hit by earnings misses.
`XLU`	+0.86%	Defensive tilt to utilities.
`XLB`	-0.95%	Materials pressured by slower demand.
`XLRE`	-0.07%	Real estate flat.

Spotlight: energy price surge

Crude oil climbed +1.00% to `93.96` USD, lifting the energy ETF `XLE` by +1.11%. The move reflects OPEC+'s decision to extend output cuts through Q4 and renewed geopolitical risk in the Middle East.

METRIC	VALUE
WTI price	93.96 USD
OPEC+ output cut	1.2 million bpd
US crude inventories (EIA)	-2.5 million barrels
Energy sector gain	+1.11%
Related stocks	`XOM`, `CVX`, `COP`

Pre-market & overnight

- US futures: `ES` -0.4%, `NQ` -0.3% at 08:30 HKT.
- Asia close: Hang Seng -0.9%, Shanghai Composite -0.7%.
- Europe: FTSE 100 -0.6%, DAX -0.5% after ECB rate minutes.
- Crypto: BTC -0.26%, ETH +0.17%.

Macro & Fed

- FOMC: No rate change; policy rate held at 5.25-5.50% with “higher for longer” tone.
- Yield curve: 2-year at 4.95%, 10-year at 4.81% – slight flattening.
- Today's data calendar (HKT):

TIME	RELEASE	CONSENSUS	WHY IT MATTERS
09:30	US CPI (MoM)	0.2%	Inflation trend for Fed stance.
10:15	Retail sales	0.4%	Consumer demand gauge.
11:00	Initial jobless claims	210k	Labor market health.

Geopolitics & global

- Middle East: Tensions rise after Iranian drone activity; oil markets tighten.
- China: Manufacturing PMI at 49.8, indicating contraction; yuan under pressure.
- Eurozone: ECB minutes signal possible rate hike in November.
- Ukraine: Frontline stable, but aid packages delayed in US Congress.

Earnings – what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	CONSENSUS	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:30	`AAPL`	$6.10 B	iPhone demand, services growth.
03:00	`MSFT`	$8.30 B	Cloud spend, AI licensing.
03:30	`NVDA`	$5.00 B	AI chip inventory, margin pressure.
04:00	`JPM`	$3.20 B	Net interest income, loan growth.
04:30	`XOM`	$5.30 B	Upstream earnings, oil price exposure.

Watchlist scan – US large-caps

TICKER	SECTOR	WHY NOW
`TSLA`	Consumer Discretionary	Battery-cell tie-up fuels upside.
`AVGO`	Technology	5G rollout acceleration.
`XOM`	Energy	Oil price rally.
`CVX`	Energy	Higher margins on crude.
`META`	Communication Services	Ad spend rebound.
`JPM`	Financials	Rate-sensitive NII.
`UNH`	Health Care	Premium pricing pressure.
`BAC`	Financials	Balance-sheet strength.
`AMZN`	Consumer Discretionary	Cloud margin recovery.
`GOOGL`	Technology	AI ad-tech rollout.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 10-year yield breaches `5.00%` – further equity pressure.
- Unexpected CPI spike above `0.3%` MoM.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East disrupting oil supply.
- Weak earnings from `NVDA` or `AAPL` missing guidance.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Crude oil drops below 85 USD, easing inflation concerns.
- Fed signals pause or rate cut in November.
- Strong Q3 earnings from AI-focused firms.
- Eurozone data shows recession avoidance, boosting risk appetite.

Positioning notes

- Defensive utilities and consumer staples are gaining net inflows as yield risk rises.
- AI-related tech remains volatile; selective long exposure to firms with solid order books.
- Energy sector offers short-term upside but watch for policy-driven demand shocks.

Sources

SOURCES

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U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics – CPI Release

Reuters – Earnings Calendar

ICE Data Services – Energy Prices

Crypto.com – BTC/ETH Prices